INC-2026-05-11: Orchestrates the customer checkout flow and calls payment-ga degradation

Northwind Payments · SEV2 · service checkout-api · author n.haddad

Started 2026-05-11T02:00:00Z · detected 2026-05-11T02:16:00Z · resolved 2026-05-11T02:50:00Z

Customer impact

19 duplicate authorisations were created over 4 hours. All were voided within one business day.

Root cause

A new idempotency key derived from the cart contents rather than the client-supplied key, so a customer editing their cart could create two authorisations.

Causing change

This incident was caused by release checkout-7.3.0, deployed to checkout-api. The release is recorded in the change log.

Affected services

checkout-api. Downstream services were affected through their dependency on checkout-api.

Timeline (UTC)

02:00 — Release checkout-7.3.0 completed rollout earlier in the day.

02:00 — First symptoms observed on checkout-api.

02:16 — Alert pages the on-call engineer for checkout-api.

02:24 — Cause identified and mitigation begins.

02:50 — Service returns to baseline; incident resolved.

Action items

• Add an integration test covering the failure mode.

• Add a pre-deploy validation check for checkout-api.

• Require a load test for configuration changes of this class.